Alloy

Tester and User Guide

Windows games on your Mac

Alloy launches free for every user.

WELCOME

01 Thanks for testing Alloy

Alloy plays Windows games on Apple silicon Macs, and it will launch free for every user: no trial, no paid tier. You're using beta 0.9.0 before release.

Alloy sets each game up for you. It reads the game's files, picks the graphics engine that suits it, turns on the faster options your Mac supports, keeps compiled shaders between plays, and explains crashes in plain English with a button that fixes them. Under the hood it uses Wine, the open-source Windows compatibility layer, with Apple's Metal graphics.

We need three things from you: which of your games run, how well they run, and where Alloy gets in your way. Section 7 shows what to test and how to report it.

FREE
for every user at launch

3–5×
faster thread wake-ups with MSync

11–21 ms
worst frame once shaders are cached

120 Hz
kept on ProMotion displays

Runs on
Apple silicon Macs (M1 or later) with macOS 14 or later.

Plays
Windows games you own: installed folders, setup files, or stores such as Steam and Epic.

Graphics
DirectX 10 and 11 through DXMT. DirectX 12 through Apple's D3DMetal, which you add yourself.

Privacy
No store passwords, no uploads. Logs stay on your Mac with passwords and tokens removed.

Play fair
Please test only with games you own legally. Alloy never asks for your Steam, Epic or Apple passwords; sign in to stores inside their own apps.

GET SET UP

02 Install Alloy

A few minutes, most of it one download.

Mac
Apple silicon (M1 or later) on macOS 14 or later. 16 GB of memory is comfortable for recent games.

Rosetta 2
Alloy's welcome guide installs it if your Mac doesn't have it yet.

Space
About 2 GB for Alloy and its game engine (the engine is 1.4 GB), plus your games.

Internet
Needed for setup and store downloads.

/ Install and open Alloy

1. Double-click **Alloy-0.9.0.zip** to unzip it, then drag **Alloy** into your **Applications** folder.
2. Double-click Alloy. The first time, macOS says it can't check Alloy for malicious software and won't open it. Click **Done**, not Move to Trash.
3. Open **System Settings › Privacy & Security** and scroll down to **Security**. Next to the message that Alloy was blocked, click **Open Anyway**, then confirm with your password or Touch ID and click **Open**.
4. Alloy opens. You only do this once; after that it opens like any other app.
5. In the welcome guide, accept the terms and click **Install Everything**. It installs Rosetta 2 if needed, the **Alloy Game Engine**, and the Windows components games commonly need. When it says **Ready**, you can add games.

Why macOS warns you
This beta isn't signed with an Apple Developer ID yet, so macOS can't confirm who made it and shows an unknown developer warning. Right-clicking and choosing Open no longer gets past it on recent macOS; use Open Anyway in System Settings as above. Only do this for a copy of Alloy you got directly from the Alloy team.

USER GUIDE

03 How to use Alloy

Three areas in the sidebar: Games, Setup and Advanced. Most people only need Games.

/ Add a game you already have

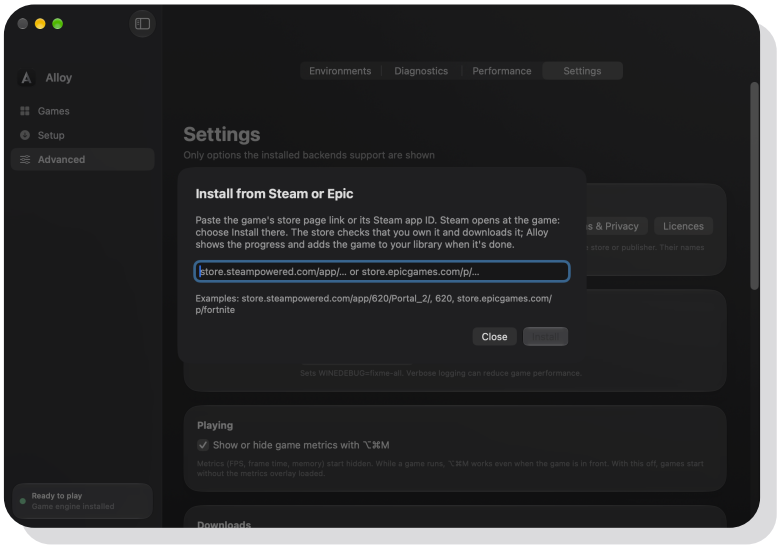
1. Go to **Games**, click **Add Game** and choose **Add Installed Game Folder…** You can also drag the folder onto the Games page.
2. Alloy finds the game's program and works out the graphics engine and Windows components it needs. Nothing runs yet.
3. Open the game's page and click **Play**. Alloy asks you to confirm the first start.

/ Install a game from its setup file

Choose **Add Game › Install from Setup File…** and pick the game's setup **.exe** or **.msi**. Alloy runs the installer in a new environment and adds the game to your library.

/ Install a game from Steam or Epic

1. In **Setup**, install Steam or the Epic Games Launcher (EA app, Ubisoft Connect, GOG Galaxy and Battle.net are there too). Sign in inside the store's own window.
2. Choose **Add Game › Install from Steam or Epic…**
3. Paste the game's store link or Steam app ID, for example store.steampowered.com/app/620 or 620.
4. The store opens at the game. Click **Install** there; the store checks that you own it.
5. Progress shows at the top of your library, and the game joins it when done. Games you install inside a store directly also appear and start through that store.



Paste a store link or a Steam app ID.

/ Pick a graphics mode

Each game page has one graphics choice:

Balanced · default

As smooth as your display allows, capped at its refresh rate for even frame pacing.

Sharp

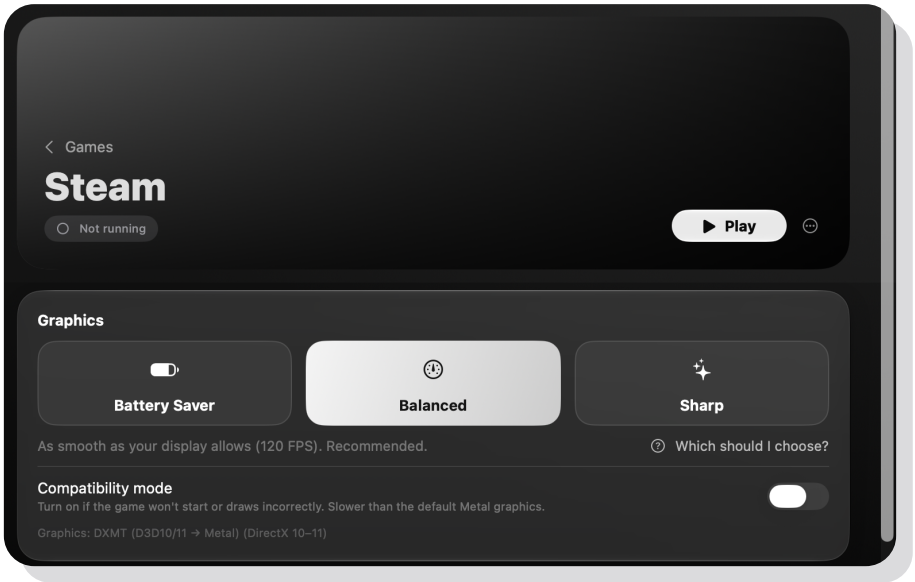
Apple MetalFX upscales every frame to your Retina resolution. Pair it with a lower in-game resolution for more FPS.

Battery Saver

Caps the game at 60 FPS for longer battery and a cooler Mac. Shown on displays faster than 60 Hz.

Compatibility mode

Wine's own OpenGL graphics. Slower; use it only if a game won't start or draws incorrectly.



A game page: Play, and the graphics modes.

/ Upscaling and frame generation

DLSS games: Alloy turns on DLSS to MetalFX automatically. Choose DLSS in the game's own settings and the game uses Apple MetalFX instead.

DLSS Frame Generation games (DirectX 12): with D3DMetal 4 added, the game page offers frame generation. Turn on DLSS Frame Generation in the game.

AMD FSR games: use the game's own FSR setting.

Other games don't get frame generation: without the game's motion data, made-up frames smear edges and add input delay.

/ Watch and measure performance

Press ⌥⌘**M** while a game runs to show or hide Apple's performance overlay (FPS, frame time, memory). It works even with the game in front.

Advanced › Performance keeps a benchmark history per game with average FPS, 1% lows and stutter counts, imports PresentMon or MangoHud logs, and recommends the best setting.

/ When something goes wrong

A crash or failed start shows **What went wrong** on the game's page: the cause in plain English and a fix button. More options sit under **More Fixes**.

Advanced › Diagnostics shows each game's last result, problems and log. **Open Logs Folder** shows the files.

A frozen game: open its page and click **Stop**.

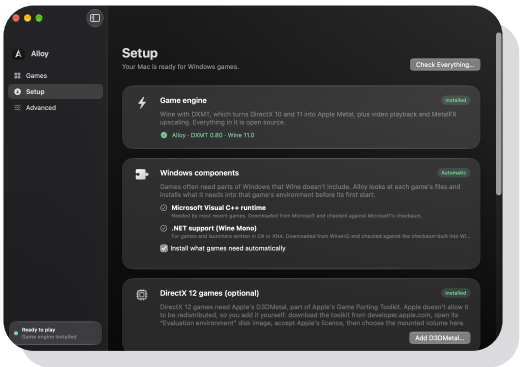
/ Remove a game

Open the game page's **…** menu and choose **Remove from Alloy…**. Only the library entry goes; your game files are never touched.

/ DirectX 12 games

1. Download Apple's Game Porting Toolkit from developer.apple.com (free Apple account).
2. Open its **Evaluation environment** disk image and accept Apple's licence.
3. In Alloy's **Setup**, click **Add D3DMetal…** and choose the mounted volume.

Apple's licence doesn't allow D3DMetal to be redistributed, so Alloy never includes it.



Setup: game engine, Windows components and DirectX 12 support.

WHAT'S INSIDE

04 Features

All of it is in the build you're testing. Figures: Alloy's test programs, M4 MacBook Pro.

/ Setup and library

Automatic game setup
Reads the game's files and picks DXMT for DirectX 10/11, D3DMetal for DirectX 12, or Compatibility mode for older games.

Windows components
Installs what each game needs, such as Visual C++ and .NET support, checked against the publisher's checksum.

Six game stores
Steam, Epic, EA app, Ubisoft Connect, GOG Galaxy and Battle.net from Setup. Steam and Epic games install from a link.

Fast starts
Each game is scanned once, and again only when its program changes: about 0.5 s saved per visit and launch.

Game Mode
Games start as macOS games, so macOS turns on Game Mode for them.

Videos in games
MP4/H.264 videos play, including Unreal Engine menu backgrounds and cutscenes.

/ Smoothness and image quality

Display-matched frame cap
Even pacing at your display's refresh rate. ProMotion MacBook Pros stay at 120 Hz even when a game asks for 60 Hz.

DLSS to MetalFX
Games that ship NVIDIA DLSS use Apple MetalFX upscaling instead, switched on automatically.

MetalFX frame generation
For DLSS Frame Generation games on DirectX 12, through D3DMetal 4, from the game's own motion data.

Protected shader cache
Shaders live in Alloy's folder, safe from macOS clean-ups. Worst frame: 47–69 ms first play, 11–21 ms after.

MSync
On by default: thread wake-ups 3–5× faster, locks about 20×. Matches Steam's setting so games still start.

Cursor stays hidden
The Mac cursor no longer pops up over a game that hid it.

/ Help and privacy

Plain-English crash help
Names the cause (CPU feature, memory, graphics, missing files, store not running) and ranks the fixes.

No stuck crash windows
Wine's technical crash window is off, so a crashed game closes within seconds.

Performance overlay
⌥⌘M shows FPS, frame time and memory in any game.

Control and privacy
No game starts without your click. No store sign-ins, no uploads; logs stay local and redacted.

THE LANDSCAPE

05 How Alloy compares

Alloy wins on price, automatic setup and help when things break, not raw speed. Every app here builds on Wine, Rosetta 2 and Apple Metal.

	Alloy	CrossOver	Sikarugir (was Kegworks)	Whisky	Game Porting Toolkit
Price	**Free**	Paid; 14-day trial	Free	Free	Free
Status	In beta, launching free	Maintained (commercial)	Maintained	Archived May 2025; no longer maintained	Maintained by Apple
Made for	Players	Players and businesses	Enthusiasts building app wrappers	Players	Developers evaluating ports
How you use it	Mac app with a game library	Mac app with bottles	Wrapper creator	Mac app with bottles	Terminal commands
Picks graphics per game	Yes, from the game's own files	Yes, from CodeWeavers' database (Auto)	Manual toggles	Manual	Manual
DirectX 10/11	DXMT, D3DMetal or OpenGL	DXMT, D3DMetal, DXVK or OpenGL	OpenGL by default; D3DMetal optional	D3DMetal	D3DMetal
DirectX 12	D3DMetal (you add it)	D3DMetal (included)	D3DMetal (optional)	D3DMetal	D3DMetal
MSync	On by default	Per bottle	–	–	–
DLSS to MetalFX	Automatic when the game ships DLSS	–	–	–	–
Crash help	Plain-English cause and fix buttons	Logs and support site	Logs	Logs	Logs
Store installs	Six stores from Setup; Steam and Epic games from a link	Steam and others via install recipes	Manual	–	Manual

– means the sources we checked don't document it, not that the app lacks it. CrossOver's store page lists a $34 12-month renewal and a $494 lifetime licence. Competitor details as of November 2026.

/ Why it matters to you

Free, no trial clock
CrossOver is polished but paid after 14 days. Whisky is free but archived, so new macOS versions and games may break it.

Nothing to tune
Alloy picks the engine, turns on DLSS to MetalFX and MSync, and matches your display. Others leave this to you.

Fixes, not log files
A crash comes with a plain-English reason and the fix that fits that game.

Honest about speed
Same engine, same settings, about the same FPS anywhere. We'll publish speed comparisons only after measuring.

Also worth knowing
Cloud gaming (GeForce NOW, Xbox Cloud Gaming) streams games from Windows PCs and is the realistic way to play titles with kernel anti-cheat on a Mac. Virtual machines such as Parallels run Windows for ARM, which many anti-cheat systems refuse.

BE AWARE

06 Known limits

Some games won't run, and a few features haven't met a real game yet.

Limit	What it means for you
Kernel anti-cheat	Riot Vanguard, FACEIT, EA Javelin, Ricochet, and the kernel parts of Easy Anti-Cheat and BattlEye block online play. They need a Windows kernel driver, which neither Wine nor macOS can provide.
DirectX 12	Needs D3DMetal from Apple's Game Porting Toolkit, added by you. 64-bit games only.
Not yet tried with a real game	MetalFX frame generation (no DLSS Frame Generation game was available) and Steam or Epic installs end to end (stores were blocked on the development network).
Games with DirectX 11 and 12	Set up on DXMT. If such a game picks DirectX 12 itself, it may not start. Please report it.
First play	Shaders are prepared the first time, so expect some stutter in the first minutes.
Other stores	EA app, Ubisoft Connect, GOG Galaxy and Battle.net install from Setup but haven't been tested further.
Intel Macs, older macOS	Not supported: Alloy needs Apple silicon and macOS 14 or later.

YOUR PART

07 What to test and how to report it

Play your own games normally, then tell us what worked and what didn't.

Test checklist

- ☐ Install Alloy and the Alloy Game Engine
- ☐ Add a game you own, and install one through Steam or Epic
- ☐ Play 30 minutes in each graphics mode the game offers
- ☐ A DLSS game, with DLSS on in its settings
- ☐ A DLSS Frame Generation game, if you own one and added D3DMetal
- ☐ Any crash: did What went wrong explain it, and did the fix help?
- ☐ Anything confusing in the app, however small

Put in every report

1. The game, and where you bought it
2. Your Mac model, memory and macOS version
3. The graphics engine and mode on the game's page
4. What happened, and steps to make it happen again
5. Optional: the log from **Advanced › Diagnostics › Open Logs Folder**. Passwords and tokens are removed; read it before sending, as it may contain folder names.

Where to send reports
To be confirmed by the Alloy team before the beta starts.

/ Sources

CodeWeavers store: CrossOver prices and trial – https://www.codeweavers.com/store
CodeWeavers: Advanced settings in CrossOver Mac 25 (MSync, graphics Auto) – https://support.codeweavers.com/en_US/advanced-settings-in-crossover-mac
It's FOSS: CrossOver 25 release (DXMT, D3DMetal) – https://itsfoss.com/news/crossover-25-release/
Whisky on GitHub: maintenance notice, archived May 11, 2025 – https://github.com/Whisky-App/Whisky
Sikarugir on GitHub: successor to Kegworks – https://github.com/Sikarugir-App/Sikarugir
Alloy measurements: docs/COMPATIBILITY.md in the Alloy repository